Foreword

Who would have thought that a landfill - and one that lies 8km away from the mainland - can also be a place where families and friends gather to admire nature's rich biodiversity and take in the scenic beauty of the open sea.

This is what Semakau Landfill offers to anyone setting foot on the island.

Semakau debunks the notion that landfills have to be smelly, dirty, and polluted; and best avoided. Instead, what the island offers is an engineering marvel set amidst the beauty of nature. Mangroves, coral reefs and other marine life thrive, thanks to the foresight of planners who saw beyond a waste management solution. We must also record the contribution of villagers who relocated to make the development possible and turned up wholeheartedly to support its launch.

The Semakau facility is not just the world's first-of-its-kind offshore landfill. It is also an innovative solution that addresses two challenges: the need for a solid waste management system that takes into account Singapore's limited land space and the need to protect natural heritage.

Activities conducted by the National Environment Agency and its partners have enabled many Singaporeans and international friends to visit Semakau to see how a landfill can be carefully managed without sacrificing nature's bounties. Many individuals and groups have contributed to its success as a uniquely Singapore attraction. Semakau is an inspiration for creative solutions for sustainable development.

As we appreciate Semakau, it is also my wish that all of us reaffirm our commitment to do our part to reduce, reuse and recycle waste and to protect our precious environment - for us and for future generations.

Dr. Yaacob Ibrahim
Minister for the Environment and Water Resources

